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Astrology in Theory and Practice gives you the foundational training for the study and practice not only of Hellenistic, but also Arabic, Medieval, and Renaissance astrological traditions. But beyond that, it supports the integration of the fruits of these ancient astrological wisdom teachings in a manner that can strengthen and deepen the way we read charts today.

The book begins simply, but gets increasingly more complex with each successive technique. Some may find the material overwhelming. However, my conviction, based upon my experience with many students whom I have guided through this process, is that if you diligently do each exercise as it appears in the text, you will be able to understand the principles and acquire the foundation for what comes next. The key to mastery lies in doing the exercises.

In the second century, Vettius Valens wrote an instructional book for one of his students which included an oath for astrologers to use the information wisely and responsibly. He compared the path to learning certain teachings to an initiate's path up a mountain peak to a temple where one could communicate with the celestial gods. The rewards far outweighed the effort it took to arrive at the destination.

> And just as a person might climb up with great effort through steps and twisting curves to some mountain peak and come upon a temple furnished with extravagant statues of deities made of gold and silver and ivory or purple vestments, this person would believe that the climb was not to be regretted nor was tiring and would worship with pleasure imagining that he is conversing with the heavenly gods, so in the same way for those who trust in our precepts.[5]

I am humbled to have the opportunity and honor to be a living link in the transmission of the ancient astrological doctrines that were formulated and practiced by our predecessors.

5 VALENS, *Anthology* 7, Preface.

Capricorn, and the last half of Sagittarius
MUTE/LACKING A VOICE (shaped in images of animals lacking a voice, stuttering, speak little): Cancer, Scorpio, Pisces

SINGLE FORM (keeping to an unshared estate): Aries, Taurus, Cancer, Leo, Libra, Scorpio, Aquarius
DUAL FORM (shared estate, companions both add and take away): Pisces and Gemini, Capricorn and Sagittarius, Virgo

FREE (running): Aries, Leo, Sagittarius; (standing erect with limbs perfectly poised): Virgo, Gemini, Aquarius
SERVILE (sitting fatigued, slouched, and weariness of mind): Taurus, Libra, Capricorn, Cancer, Scorpio, Pisces

LICENTIOUS/INDECENT: Aries, Taurus, Capricorn, Pisces, and Libra in part
LECHEROUS/LEWD: Aries, Taurus, Leo, Capricorn in part, Pisces, and Libra (because the constellation of the Goat rises with it)[6]
VIOLENT/DESTRUCTIVE (domicile or exaltation of malefic planets): Aries, Libra, Scorpio, Capricorn, Aquarius
BROKEN/IMPERFECT/MUTILATED (distortions of body and limbs): Taurus, Leo, Scorpio, Pisces, Capricorn, Cancer
ROUGH-SKINNED, LEPROUS, MANGY, SCURVY: Aries, Taurus, Cancer, Scorpio, Capricorn, Pisces
WHOLE/PERFECT (strong, robust, less liable to accidents): Gemini, Libra, Aquarius

In the ancient literature, many of these traits were associated with the Ascendant sign and the Moon sign, which both signify the physical body, rather than the Sun, which is more connected to the soul. When individuals act upon their core instincts, they may express some of the animal behaviors represented by images of the zodiacal signs prominent in their birth chart.

→ EXERCISE 9

Having reviewed table 10, complete exercise 9: Characteristics of the Zodiacal Signs

6 See RHETORIUS, *Compendium* 76.

Jupiter is Mars, overseer of death, exalted in Capricorn. Thus Mars, lord of death (Nergal in Babylonian myth), has its fall in Cancer where the life-breath increases; and conversely Jupiter has its fall in Capricorn, where death increases.

The oppositions of the exaltations of Mercury and Venus point to increase in intellectual stimulation (Mercury in Virgo) versus decrease in sexual desire (Venus in Virgo); conversely, the place where longing and pleasure increases (Venus in Pisces) is where the intellectual stimulus falls (Mercury in Pisces).

Rhetorius gives the following explanation for why no planet is exalted in Scorpio:

> Where the Moon is exalted, no planet has its fall, and where the Moon has its fall, no planet is exalted. It is said that the Moon is the Fortune of all, and he whom fortune exalts, no one can bring down, and he whom Fortune brings down, no one is able to exalt.[6]

If a planet is not in the zodiacal sign of its exaltation, investigating its relationship with its exaltation lord can provide additional details. It is the responsibility of its exaltation lord, whichever planet that is, to provide honors to the planet in question. But depending upon the exaltation lord and its relationship to the planet, it may or may not have the capacity or willingness to do so. Again, for a more finely-tuned evaluation, you must investigate whether the planet is connected to its exaltation lord by a whole sign aspect, and whether or not it is a sect mate.

→ EXAMPLE CHARTS

Look at each planet in turn to discover its exaltation lord, and to determine if it is the recipient of any special powers of esteem. This is the formula that you need to repeat in your head in order to get the correct response:

CHART I: THE SUN IS IN LEO. *Which planet is the exaltation lord of Leo? There is no exaltation lord of Leo. Therefore I will put a dash in the blank space for the Sun's exaltation lord.* THE MOON IS IN ARIES. *Which planet is the exaltation lord of Aries? The Sun is the exaltation lord of Aries. Therefore I will put the Sun in the blank space for the exaltation lord for the Moon. Whatever honor the Moon receives is the responsibility of the Sun. If Venus were in Pisces, for instance (which it is not in this chart), the formula would read:* VENUS IS IN PISCES. *Which planet is the exaltation lord of Pisces? Venus. Therefore I will put Venus in the blank space*

6 RHETORIUS, *Compendium* 7.

OTHER USES OF THE TRIPLICITY LORDS

The triplicity lords of the sect light (Sun or Moon) was an important technique used by Hellenistic astrologers to determine the overall eminence and fortune of an individual's life. Dorotheus of Sidon, one of the earliest Hellenistic astrologers, used the triplicity lords extensively for many other considerations. He often employed the three triplicity lords of a zodiacal sign (its day lord, night lord, and cooperating lord) rather than the domicile lord for judgments on the various significations of that house. He wrote that "everything which is decided and indicated comes to be from the lords of the triplicities [trigons]".[2]

Dorotheus' work was one of the primary sources for the Arabic astrologers. Al-Andarzaghar said, "the first lord of the triplicity of the house of death [i.e. the eighth] signifies death, and the second one ancient things, and the third inheritance".[3] Thus if a person with a day chart has the zodiacal sign Gemini occupying the eighth house, the first lord Saturn signifies his death; the second lord Mercury signifies ancient things related to him; and the third lord Jupiter signifies his inheritances. Because Dorotheus' work was translated and used by Persian and Arabic astrologers, triplicity lords became an integral part of the astrology that was then passed on into the Medieval era.

The Hellenistic astrologers used the first two triplicity lords, the day lord and night lord, to rule over the first and second parts of life, while the Arabic and Medieval astrologers also took the third cooperating triplicity lord for indications on the third part of life. The condition of each triplicity lord in the natal chart gave indications about the good or bad fortune during the part of life over which it had jurisdiction. In Hellenistic astrology, the changeover from the first to second part of life was timed to the planetary periods of the triplicity lords and the ascensional times of their signs.[4]

RATIONALE FOR TRIPLICITY LORDS AND THE JOYS OF THE HOUSES

We are going to introduce another seminal chart that is used primarily to illustrate the integrated structure that stands behind the twelve houses. It also serves a secondary purpose in giving hints for the underlying structure of the triplicity

2 DOROTHEUS, *Carmen* 1.1.8, trans. DYKES.

3 As cited by AL-QABISI (*Introduction to the Science of Astrology* 1.64) in BONATTI, *Book of Astronomy* 2.3.5, trans. DYKES.

4 VALENS, *Anthology*, 2.2.

first house, part of which can be above the horizon and part below, depending upon the degree of the Ascendant.

Robert Schmidt first made the observation that the triplicity lords tended to cluster around the four angular houses. The two primary triplicity lords of fire, the Sun and Jupiter, flank the tenth house and their cooperating triplicity lord, Saturn, is adjacent to Jupiter; the two primary triplicity lords of air, Saturn and Mercury, are near the first house and their cooperating triplicity lord, Jupiter, is adjacent to Saturn. The two primary triplicity lords of earth, Venus and the Moon, surround the fourth house and their cooperating triplicity lord Mars is adjacent to Venus; one of the two primary triplicity lords of water, Mars, is next to the seventh house.

Chris Brennan expanded upon these insights, discussing how this scheme informed which of the four elements came to be associated with each triplicity.[5] Looking at Aristotle's doctrine of natural place, fire is the lightest element that rises to the top of the cosmos, while earth is the heaviest element that settles to the lowest regions. Air rises upwards and settles below fire, while water settles downwards and rests upon earth. Once the natural position of each element is linked to its corresponding placement upon the wheel of houses, the assignment of the triplicity lords to their element follows accordingly. The Sun and Jupiter at the top of the chart belong to fire at the heights, while Venus and the Moon at the bottom of the chart belong to earth at the depths. Mercury and Saturn at the Ascendant belong to air that rises up, while Mars belongs to water that sinks downward.[6]

→ EXAMPLE CHARTS

Let us now determine whether any planet is its own triplicity lord. Keep in mind that it is not unusual if there are not any planets in their own triplicities, but when they are it is an important indicator that the planet possesses a power of a special nature.

5 BRENNAN, *Hellenistic Astrology*, p. 258.

6 It is important to note that CLAUDIUS PTOLEMY changed the rulers of the water triplicity, and eliminated the cooperating rulers altogether. Some Medieval and classical Renaissance astrology, especially the work of William Lilly, is derived directly from the Ptolemaic tradition and adheres to his convention.

When you look at a chart and see Mercury or Venus conjunct the Sun and in direct motion, you know they are moving at their fastest daily speed. If you see that they are retrograde and conjunct the Sun, you know that they are slower than average. The slowest motion occurs at both station points.

DETERMINING SPEED AND DAILY MOTION

There is software for calculating the speed of each planet on any given date. If you know the average daily motion, you can determine if, on that day, the planet is traveling faster or slower than its daily rate. Some programs will also note if the planet is increasing or decreasing in speed. Historically, this was an important consideration in horary and medical inquiries.[1]

Hellenistic texts used the phrases *additive in numbers* and *subtractive in numbers* when discussing a planet's motion. Generally, *additive in numbers* referred to a planet in direct motion, and *subtractive in numbers* referred to a planet in retrograde motion. However, arguments can also be made for these terms being used to indicate a planet increasing or decreasing its speed. However, this notion is more accurately called *moving towards the greater or lesser extent of a planet's course.*

INTERPRETING SPEED AND DIRECTION

> And if [the stars] occupy the first station and are found to be stepping backwards, the matters that were previously determined, actions, profits, and undertakings are delayed. Likewise, even if the stars rise at sunset (acronychal), they are weak, thwarting, foretelling only illusions and hopes. And if, in any way, they come to the second station, they remove the hindrances, restore the same matters, and they bring stability and successful accomplishment of the livelihood. But if they are carried under the setting phase, they bring hindrances and troubles in what is being accomplished, and also bodily dangers, weaknesses,

1 You can also determine the planet's daily motion by looking at an ephemeris. Subtract the longitude of a planet (as given in degrees and minutes) from its position on the day before. This figure tells you the distance it has traveled within a twenty-four hour period. You can then compare this to its average to assess its relative average speed on that day. If you then subtract the longitude of the planet's position on the following day, you can compare the two sums and see whether the figure on the day after is larger or smaller than the figure on the day before. This will tell you if the planet is speeding up or slowing down. If the number is larger than the day before, the planet's speed is increasing. If it is smaller than on the day before, the planet's speed is decreasing.

from the conjunction with the Sun while he is in retrograde motion (Sun 8° Scorpio, Mercury 23° Scorpio retrograde). Thus, Mercury has a phase transition intensification condition on the seventh day after the birth. Mercury is effective, intensely saturating the life with mercurial significations, but is rapidly approaching his weakening, both through retrograde and heliacal set. Mercury flashes with great intensity, then crashes.

→ EXERCISE 20

Using your own chart, complete exercise 20: Phase and Phasis

creatures, which all change with the increasing and decreasing nature of the Moon.[2] Above all, she was the main significator of conception and the health and illnesses of the human body. More than that, all prosperity and fortune related to the creature comforts of life were also under her dominion.

Many spiritual teachings hold that the body is the temple of the soul, pointing to the union of the lunar and solar principles within human life. Eastern philosophies speak of the "precious human rebirth", in that it is only while being alive within a body that humans have the possibility of spiritual realization. In the Hellenistic astrological texts, the Moon is one of the five "places of life". She represents both the physical body itself, as well as the necessary matrix in which the process of spiritual transcendence can take place.

There are a number of special concepts related to the Moon that we shall discuss in the following section. Some of them influence the condition of the Moon herself in the nativity, and others impact the condition of the planets to which she is joined in various ways.

LUNAR APPLICATIONS AND SEPARATIONS

> Without the matter of separation and application [of the Moon], neither longevity, nor brevity of life, nor sickness, nor injury, nor wealth, nor misfortune, nor fame, nor obscurity, nor manliness, nor weakness is established in the nativity. — PAULUS.[3]

The Moon is the planet that is closest to the Earth. Due to her swift motion, she circles the entire zodiac every month. Along her course she is able to make applying aspects with each of the other planets. As she does so, she was thought to gather up their effluences and transmit them to Earth. It follows that if the Moon applies to a planet, she is able to help bring down and make manifest the significations of that planet into the terrestrial realm. Thus, an application (applying aspect) from the Moon improves the planet's condition by bringing its matters to fruition.

An applying aspect from the Moon occurs when the Moon is moving towards a planet, either bodily by conjunction or by aspect ray. In this case, the Moon will be in a lesser degree than the planet. A separating aspect occurs when the Moon has already made contact with the planet and is now moving away from it. In this case, the Moon will be in a greater degree than the planet. For

2 PORPHYRY, *Introduction* 2.
3 PAULUS, *Introduction* 17.

THE FOURFOLD DIVISION mirrors the solar cycle, where the critical turning points of increasing and decreasing light at the four quarters of the Moon correspond to the increase and decrease of solar light marked by the equinoxes and solstices. Ptolemy explains how the Moon is more productive of moisture in its waxing from New Moon to First Quarter; of heat in its passage from First Quarter to Full; of dryness from Full to Last Quarter; and of cold from Last Quarter to occultation (New Moon).[1] Porphyry relates how the Moon's first appearance until the First Quarter is like spring; and thence to the Full Moon like summer; from there to the Second Quarter like autumn; and next down to its disappearance (at New Moon) like winter.[2] The quarters of the Moon were very important in the timing of the critical days during the course of an illness. It is also the basis of a Hellenistic time-lord technique called "Quarters of the Moon".

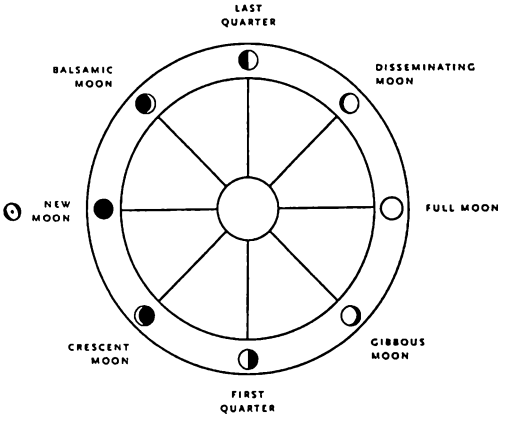


FIGURE 49. EIGHTFOLD DIVISION OF THE LUNAR CYCLE
The eight quarters of the lunar cycle add the halfway points between solstices and equinoxes.

When these four quarters are subdivided once again, THE EIGHTFOLD DIVISION corresponds to the addition of the cross quarter days which stand midway between each solstice and equinox. This was ritualized in the pagan holiday celebratory rites of the wheel of the year—Winter Solstice, Candlemas, Spring Equinox, Beltane (May Day), Summer Solstice, Lammas, Autumn Equinox, and Hallomas (Halloween).

1 PTOLEMY, *Tetrabiblos* 1.8.
2 PORPHYRY, *Introduction* 2.

One popular method investigates the state of the Moon at the time a person becomes ill. The Moon's speed, waxing or waning light, and configuration to the benefic and malefic planets are taken into consideration and provide the basis for a diagnosis as to the origin, cause, course, critical days, and prognosis of the illness.

The Moon has an average motion of 13° per day, but in the course of the lunar month, its motion varies from as little as 11° per day near apogee (when the Moon is farthest from the Earth), to as much as 15° per day near perigee (when the Moon is nearest to the Earth). In general, when the Moon is fast ("additive in numbers") or increases in speed, the illness is active and increases, but when the Moon is slow ("subtractive in numbers") or decreases in speed, the illness is less active and slows down.

In the analysis of a chart at the moment a person takes to bed ill, a Moon that is fast, waxing, and conjunct/square/opposed to Mars indicates a severe illness due to overheating (such as inflammations and fevers), while a Moon that is slow, waning, and conjunct/square/opposed to Saturn points to cold and constrictive diseases (such as bronchitis and paralysis). If the Moon is also witnessed by Venus or Jupiter, especially by conjunction, sextile, or trine, recovery is indicated.

If, at the time of the onset of the illness, the Moon was under the bond, it was carefully observed as to its increasing or decreasing speed after it was loosened from the bond. If it was released after the New Moon conjunction, and it traveled toward the greater extent of its course (i.e., towards its fastest speed), the illness would become severely acute as it reached the opposition, and could be destructive. But if after leaving the bond, the Moon traveled toward the lesser extent of its course (i.e., towards its slowest speed), the patient would recover, as the crisis of the opposition was behind them.[2]

The lunar phases were an essential component of another system of medical diagnosis known as the *doctrine of critical days*. First suggested by Hippocrates in the fifth century BCE, it was based upon the idea that diseases reach critical turning points, for better or worse, after a certain interval of days from the onset of the illness. Galen, the second-century Roman physician, attempted to provide a rational explanation for the critical days theory. The Moon was thought to govern changes in the atmosphere, which in turn affected changes on Earth and thus in the human body, which was composed of the same elements. The strongest changes occur at the New Moon, followed by the Full Moon (14th

One's Bed and Illnesses (*Peri katakleison kai noson*), in CCAG 1, pp. 122–124.

2 *Iatromathematika: From Hermes to Ammun to Egyptian*, in J. L. IDELER, *Physici et Medici gracci minores* (Berlin 1841), vol. 1, pp. 387–396; 430–440.

day), lesser changes at quarters (waxing 7th day; waning 20th–21st day), weak changes at crescent (4th day) and gibbous (11th day). Each consecutive lunar phase correlated to the critical days when there were thought to be changes in the course of an illness.

Astrologers adapted this model and superimposed it upon the lunar phase cycle. They posited that the cycle began in whatever sign the Moon was located in at the onset of illness, regardless of the Moon's actual objective phase in the sky. The patient was thought to undergo critical changes in the course of their illness on the days when the Moon made phase aspects to her position at the inception of the illness. On these critical days, the Moon would be investigated as to its contacts with the benefic or malefic planets in order to judge if the illness would worsen or improve, and suggestions were made as to appropriate treatments.[3]

Dorotheus of Sidon (circa 75 CE) made a direct analogy between the critical days and the days of the lunar cycle, and spoke to the role of the Moon's phases in tracking the course of the disease:

> Note the position of the Moon at the time of becoming ill. Look in the daily ephemerides to where the Moon has moved after 7 days to the square aspect figure, after 9 days it goes to the trine figure in the inception chart, after 14 days it will clearly oppose its own position, after 19 days it will go to the right trine figure, and after 21 days it will have come to its own right square figure. It is necessary to accurately examine these five figures of the Moon, and which of the stars, after the inception chart, the Moon is about to conjoin. For if [the Moon] conjoins a benefic, health comes to pass, but if a malefic, illness and harm.[4]

3 Glen M. COOPER, *Galen, De diebus decretoriis, from Greek into Arabic: A Critical Edition, with Translation and Commentary, of Hunayn ibn Ishāq, Kitāb ayyām al-buḥrān* (Surrey: Ashgate, 2011); DOROTHEUS, *Carmen* 5.42; HEPHAISTIO, *Apotelesmatics* 3.3.31; DOROTHEUS, *Fragment* 5.41; Nicholas CULPEPPER, *Astrological Judgment of Diseases from the Decumbiture of the Sick* (Astrology Classics, 2005).

4 DOROTHEUS, *Fragment* 5.41, 12–14 (CCAG 1, p. 123), in HEPHAISTIO, *Apotelesmatics* 3, Appendix F, trans. GRAMAGLIA, ed. DYKES

from the degree of the Ascendant towards the Midheaven. One then calculates the number of years between this point and the Ascendant in accordance with the ascensional times of each of the zodiacal signs for the latitude of the birth. This technique may be beyond the scope of the beginning student, but we have included it for the advanced student, who is referred to Valens for a full discussion and exposition.[4]

The prenatal lunation degree marks the syzygy between the Sun and Moon, when they are either united at the conjunction or diametrically polarized at the opposition. To the extent that the Sun and Moon signify the soul and body respectively, on a spiritual level this syzygy of the lights may speak to the moment when the soul is fully united with the body. Everyone born within a two-week period shares this moment of the unification of the soul and body as they will have the very same prenatal lunation degree and lord of that degree. Of course, the prenatal lunation and its lord will vary by house location for each person. However, on a broader, soul level, the prenatal lunation may address concepts regarding the incarnation of individuals who, in addition to their individual path, also share a collective intention and destiny.

→ EXAMPLE CHARTS

Let us determine the PNL *(prenatal lunation) for each of our charts, and note if its sign is either in the Ascending sign (first house) or the Midheaven sign (tenth house).*

CHART I: MOON'S CONDITION: PRENATAL LUNATION

Moon sign and degree	*Prenatal lunation*
25° ARIES 36′	28° Capricorn

ANALYSIS

Chart I has a WANING MOON at 25° Aries. Therefore, we search for the previous Full Moon just before birth, which occurred on July 21 at 28° Capricorn. The PNL thus falls in the third house, and the lord, Saturn, falls in the second.

4 VALENS, *Anthology* 3.9–10.

for the well-being of the person.

The Hellenistic aspect doctrine in its entirety is a complex and sophisticated vision of the cosmic dance of the planets. This aspect doctrine has been one of the most challenging parts of the Hellenistic astrological system to translate, understand, and integrate into the reconstruction of the practice. The basic components are contained in a series of definitions found in the texts of Antiochus and Porphyry (which may have originated from some other common but unknown source), and then repeated by Hephaistio and Rhetorius.[1]

While many of the definitions are broadly similar in each of the texts, the various versions reveal disagreements over some critical details. Some manuscripts even by the same author differ, and some manuscripts have different lines of transmission. The definitions have names that seem strange and exotic to our contemporary ears. It has been extremely challenging for those of us translating and reconstructing the aspect doctrine to find translations for these words that aptly convey their meanings, which have been a struggle to fully understand in the first place. So be aware that in your studies you may encounter different words used by different contemporary authors to refer to the same original concept. In some cases, I will use the Greek technical term because so far, as a community, we cannot settle upon a satisfactory English translation for the concept. Here is a short list of various aspect terms described in the Hellenistic texts. The term in Greek is followed by the term I'll use throughout this manual.

EPIMARTURIA	Witnessing
DEXIOS & EUŌNUMOS	Right and Left Figures
PARALLAGĒ	Passing Beyond
SUNAPHĒ	Connecting
KOLLĒSIS	Adherence
SUNODOS	Meeting
APORROIA	Separation
PERISCHESIS	Containment
EMPERISCHESIS	Enclosure
MESEMBOLĒSIS	Intervention

1 ANTIOCHUS, *Summary*, CCAG 7.3, pp. 111–119. PORPHYRY, *Introduction to Ptolemy's Tetrabiblos*, CCAG 5.4, pp. 187–228. HEPHAISTIO OF THEBES, *Apotelesmatics* (Leipzig: Teubner, 1973). RHETORIUS OF EGYPT, *Compendium*, CCAG 1, pp. 140–64; CCAG 8.4, pp. 115–24. For translations and commentary, see Robert SCHMIDT, *Definitions and Foundations* (Cumberland, MD: The Golden Hind Press, 2009); HOLDEN, *Introduction to the Tetrabiblos* (Tempe, AZ: American Federation of Astrologers, 2009); SCHMIDT, *Apotelesmatics* 1 and 2; GRAMAGLIA, *Apotelesmatics* 3, ed. DYKES (Minneapolis, MN: Cazimi Press, 2013); GEORGE (in the present volume).

It is useful to compare the similarities and differences in the definitions of witnessing provided by Antiochus and Porphyry. These definitions provide an overview of the entire aspect doctrine. We will unpack each of the concepts in the discussion that follows.

> ANTIOCHUS: [Antiochus told] How the stars are said to bear witness to one another whenever they are tetragons or triplicities or diameters or hexagons of one another, and at how many intervals (zodiacal signs) each one of these foresaid [figures] is configured. And how the trigonal figure is sympathetic and helpful, even if one of the stars is a destroyer, for it is less harmful; the tetragon is the opposite, even if the star is benefic; the diameter is adversarial, but worse when a malefic star is present; the hexagon is less effective than the others. The aforementioned figures are brought about according to two different ways, either simply by zodiacal sign or by degree. Wherefore many times the stars that are triangular to each other according to zodiacal signs are not triangular according to the degrees; so it is with the other figures.[2]

> PORPHYRY: They call the configurations of the stars towards each other bearing witness. There are the following figures: the trigon is through five [intervals] whenever there are three zodiacal signs between the two; the tetragon is through four [intervals] whenever there are two zodiacal signs between them; the diameter is through seven [intervals] whenever there are five in the middle; and the hexagon is through three [intervals] whenever there is one between them. And the trigon is sympathetic and helpful, and even if a destructive star is there, it is less damaging. The tetragon is harsh and unsympathetic and capable of causing pain if a destructive star is present. The diameter is adversarial, but worse if a malefic star is present. The hexagon is less efficacious. It is necessary to consider if the figures are perfect by degree and not only according to zodiacal sign. The triangular figure is at an interval of 120°, the tetragon at an interval of 90°, the hexagon at an interval of 60°, the diameter at an interval of 180°. For often [stars] are configured according to zodiacal sign, but not further according to degree.[3]

2 ANTIOCHUS, *Summary* 6.
3 PORPHYRY, *Introduction* 8.

ENCLOSURE BY BODILY PRESENCE AND A RAY: Saturn at 23° Cancer is *enclosed by benefics* when Venus, at 25° Cancer (bodily proximity), and the square ray of Jupiter, at 17° Libra, falls at 17° Cancer. We might surmise that in this example, Saturn is overcoming Jupiter by the superior square, which it is; but nevertheless, Jupiter still protects Saturn. There are some circumstances in life where the victim is moved or forced to protect the abuser (FIGURE 78).

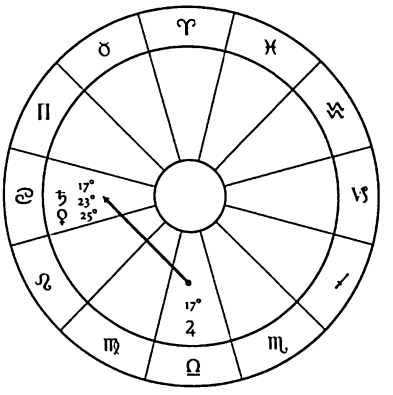


FIGURE 78.
ENCLOSURE BY BODILY PRESENCE AND RAY
Saturn is enclosed between Venus (physical proximity) and Jupiter (square ray).

CONTAINMENT (*perischesis*) is a variation on enclosure. It occurs when a single planet sends two of its rays onto either side of another planet. The example given by Porphyry has the Moon in Virgo and Mars in Aries.[2] Mars sends a trine ray into Leo, the sign to the right of the Moon, and an opposition ray into Libra, the sign to the left of the Moon. He concludes that the Moon is encompassed by destructive rays (FIGURE 79).

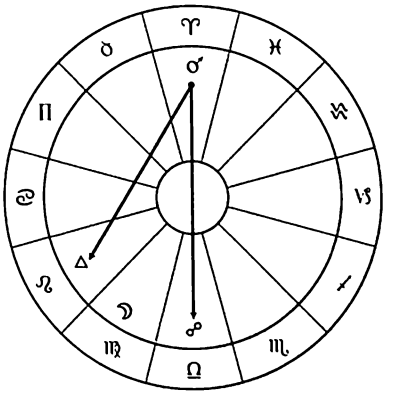


FIGURE 79.
ENCLOSURE BY CONTAINMENT
Mars contains the Moon by two rays: a trine to Leo, and an opposition to Libra. The two signs that receive the rays flank Virgo.

This example tells us several things. The first is that containment, like enclosure, can operate by whole sign configurations. In the above example, Mars in Aries is in aversion to the Moon in Virgo, and while it cannot impact it directly, its rays can still contain it (assuming there are no interventions) by means of the signs to which it is configured (Leo

2 PORPHYRY, *Introduction* 14.

CHART II: ENCLOSURE, CONTAINMENT, INTERVENTION

	Degree range	*Enclosed*	*Contained*	*Intervention*
MALEFICS	9°–12°	None	None	None
BENEFICS	4–23°	Mars	None	Saturn intervenes. Mars is not bonified.

→ EXERCISE 35

Using your own chart, complete exercise 35:
Maltreatment and Bonification by Enclosure or Containment

CHAPTER 53

Sign-based Sympathies

AND PLANETARY CONNECTIONS

THE THIRD GENERAL CATEGORY OF PLANETARY COMBINATIONS IS BASED upon zodiacal signs alone. Here, planets interact with one another in ways that are not based upon testimony from planetary aspects. Zodiacal signs that share the same *ascensional time*, the same *domicile lord*, that *see and perceive one another*, and that *command and obey one another* share sympathetic relations. This is especially significant for planets that occupy the sets of zodiacal signs that are in aversion, giving them a connection they would not otherwise have.

The aversion, a non-aspect in Hellenistic astrology, is called the quincunx, inconjunct, or disconjunt aspect (30° and 150°) in modern astrology. From a Hellenistic perspective, planets in aversion cannot "see" each other and thus have a blind spot or disconnect regarding each other's significations. Paulus writes that planets in aversion are "disharmonious":

> Sometimes they bring upon enmities and factionalisms, other times separations and exiles when such a stance is adopted by all, whether by parents towards children, by brothers, by man and wife, by an association, by slaves and masters, and by all such like.[1]

In some cases, the sympathies between certain zodiacal signs which we will describe below can offset, or mitigate, the difficulty that planets have when they are in aversion to one another. The planets can still share sympathetic relations, sometimes referred to as a "mitigating sympathy", and interpreted as a "reluctant conjunction". In other cases, presence in certain sets of zodiacal signs can intensify the existing aspects between planets located in those signs.

1 PAULUS, *Introduction* 11.

SPEAR-BEARING BODYGUARDS can be difficult or even impossible to determine based upon the available textual evidence. However, in the cases where the pattern is obvious, spear-bearers indicate eminence in the nativity, especially in regards to the planet that is guarded or attended.

MITIGATION, COUNTERACTION, AND TRANSMUTATION

> When the benefics are not involved, the person who is ill will die immediately up to the opposition [of the Moon to the malefic planet]. When the benefics are present beholding the Moon from the right, even though the patient is endangered, he will recover.[3]

When astrologers reach a judgment about a planet that is less than optimal, and the indications point to severe difficulties in a particular area of life, the question arises as to whether anything can be done to reverse the prognosticated outcomes. Many astrologers recount situations from their client files where something seemingly bad turned out to be a blessing in disguise. This observation is often used as a warning against saying anything negative about a planet because we may not know the final outcome of the situation.

However, there are indications in the chart to guide the astrologer's judgment about the possibility of reversals, improvement, and healing. After determining the fairness or poorness of a planet's condition, other patterns in the chart may require us to alter our judgment.

Traditional astrologers saw Jupiter as the greater benefic and Venus as the lesser benefic. In medical diagnosis, if the significator of an illness was afflicted, it portended the onset of a disease that could be life-threatening. However, many texts added that if the significator was witnessed by the benefics, the patient would recover.[4] From this we can extrapolate that recovery from pain, distress, trauma, or failure is possible if a planet is in a difficult condition, but has a trine with Jupiter (especially an applying trine to Jupiter, and even better, a 3° *sunaphē* bonification). To a lesser extent, this is also true for Venus, particularly in a night chart. Other forms of bonification, such as enclosure by the benefics, or being overcome by Jupiter in a superior trine or even square aspect, lead us to

3 *Iatromathematika: From Hermes to Ammun to Egyptian*; J. L. IDELER, *Physici et Medici gracci minores*, vol. 1, Berlin 1841, pp. 387–96; 430–40.

4 Ibid.

MASTER TABLES: PICASSO

BIRTH DATA: *October 25, 1881; 11:15 pm; Málaga, Spain*
SECT OF CHART: *Nocturnal*

THE SUN: 02° SCORPIO 42'

NATURE *Benefic/malefic/ common/luminary*	Luminary
SECT *Day/night, Same/contrary*	Day, contrary
SECT REJOICING *Hemisphere, Sign, Solar Phase*	Does not rejoice by sign
LORDS *Domicile, Exaltation, Triplicity, Bound*	Mars, —, Mars, Mars
ESSENTIAL DIGNITY *Domicile, Detriment, Exaltation, Fall, Mutual Reception*	None
SOLAR PHASE *Speed, Direction, Station, Visibility/Beams/Chariot, Morning/Evening, Phasis*	n/a (Sun defines category)
LUNAR ASPECTS *Lunar application Nodal Connection*	None
TESTIMONY *Favorable/Unfavorable* *Maltreated/Bonified*	Unfavorable from Saturn Maltreated by Mars
CONDITION OF DOMICILE LORD *Helps/Hinders*	Sympathetic trine of dubious assistance
JUDGMENT GRADE A/B/C/D/F	C

* = PLANET IS ITS OWN LORD